

The Art of Enduring Prayer

First Corinthians 12 once again starts out:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

We will pick it up with the twenty-seventh verse as we pass in review briefly. Please extend your faith this way and agree with me.

Heavenly Father, we thank You and praise You again for the great Teacher, the person of the Holy Spirit. Because we have Him, we do not have to take creeds and doctrines that originate with men, powerless. We have pure access to the best You have, and because of Him, we do not have to settle for anything less than Your best, because You sent the mighty person of the Holy Spirit to take us from what we are to what Jesus said we could be.

Father, we tune our spirits attentively to what You would have to say. My God, Father, You are my God. Teach me. Please, Father, teach me how more accurately to turn myself completely over to You. As Your children, we are so very careful to give You all the praise, all the honor, and all the glory, in Jesus' precious name.

Everybody said, Amen.

We found out from verse 1 that Paul said, "Concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant." That makes us even, because if there is any area I do not want to be ignorant in, it is concerning the operations of spiritual gifts.

We found out there are nine gifts of the Spirit that empower five ministry offices. These nine gifts not only empower these five ministry offices, but they qualify them. These five ministry offices are apostle, prophet, teacher, pastor, and evangelist.

These nine gifts that empower and qualify the five offices are enveloped in eight entire operations of God that constitute the entire body of Christ. God does nothing outside of these eight operations. They are enveloped in a container.

These eight operations are listed from verse 27 on:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

If you are born again, you are called to fill one of these eight operations.

The first is apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers. After that, miracles, then gifts of healings, which envelop and qualify pastor and evangelist. Then helps, the sixth operation of God; governments, the seventh operation; and finally, at the bottom, the eighth operation all the others rest upon: diversities of tongues.

We found out that the reason he called it diverse tongues is because "diverse" means different manifestations of the supernatural languages of tongues.

All the other seven operations of God rest upon this one because, of all the operations of God, this is the one where God is freed, loosed by you, to get involved on the inside of your spirit, the place within you where all permanent change takes place.

This is why Jesus called a man's heart a treasury:

| A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things...

Out of the treasury of a good man's heart, good things come to pass. Out of the treasury of an evil man's heart, evil things come to pass. Whatever you are producing in your heart is what you are conforming to. It is not your choice, except that it is your choice to change what is in there.

He called it a treasury for the same reason we call the U.S. Treasury a treasury, because it contains the wealth the United States needs to keep the wheels of progress turning. Your human spirit, under the residency of the Holy Spirit, supplies all the power for permanent change in your character so you can become the more-than-conqueror Jesus said you could be.

Why do you think the devil fought tongues so hard? Why is he so dreadfully fearful of that seemingly lowly operation that you and I have, for the most part, almost remained indifferent to?

What is it about that operation that made him eliminate it through the Dark Ages and discredit it in the great Azusa Street Pentecostal age? What is he so afraid of?

Out of all the operations of God, the seven rest upon this one. It is this operation where you invite the person of the Holy Spirit to move inside and begin to effect change in the part of you where all permanent change comes from.

This is why Paul says it is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body. Many of you, through extreme disciplined willpower, have disciplined yourself against certain things of the flesh, only to your dismay to have them grow back because you failed to kill the root.

You must understand who has come to take up His residency on the inside of you.

If I could push on your earlobe and your spirit would produce a photograph, I could pull that photograph out and examine it, and it would be an exact picture of the circumstances surrounding your life. If your life at that point were not like the picture, it would not be very long before it conformed to it again.

I was driving through Tulsa and saw a house with the picket fence falling down, the paint peeling, the screen door falling off, cars on blocks in the yard, and grass overgrown. The Lord said to me, "The outside of that house is an exact picture of the inside of the man who lives in it."

I ran home and mowed my lawn.

He said, "Do you know the difference between that man and Sam Walton?"

I said, "Yes, about eight billion dollars."

He said, "No. The only difference between the two is what is working on the inside of the man. You can take that man, and if he wins the lottery, buys a big house, gets a swimming pool and a new Corvette, it will not be very long before the pool is gunked up, the house is beat up, and the lawn is overgrown, because the man has no initiative."

I can preach to you the love of God. I can beg you, exhort you, extol you. You have to know about the love of God. I can coerce you, but I cannot open you up and put it on the inside of you. That is beyond my limitations.

I can tell you about initiative, such a powerful force that it can cause you to conquer anything, but I cannot open you up and put it inside you.

This is what we preachers have been guilty of. Through denominationalism, we have struck a dependency in the people toward us. They look to us, and we have dominated them by super-submission and fear. We have controlled them instead of doing what we were supposed to do: make disciples out of them, teach them how to turn themselves over in the eighth operation to the Holy Ghost so He can change them, then turn them over to Jesus and strike a dependency on Him, not on you.

Our goal is supposed to be to get you to a place where, if they threw you in a prison in Siberia, you would smile out of the jail cell and say, "I am complete in Him. I am complete in Him."

What do you think the devil has fought the eighth operation so hard? In diversities of tongues, men of giant intellect, talent, and charisma love to bypass that eighth operation. If they can run a government of God in the natural, then they will be glory-hunting, intelligent, charismatic, talented men who will do it.

Most of them do not mind harvesting you year after year to build their empire. They will take your wool in the middle of winter and keep building their empire, because the glory, admiration of men, and success is as addictive as cocaine. They will lay you on the altar and shear you during the winter, and you will not even know who did it.

They do not care if you go year after year through their operation and come out the other side not one bit different from when you went in.

Do you want to know why there seems to be a limit on churches? It hurt me as much as anybody. My Father told me, "I have not been able to get this bunch of preachers yet to the place where they can instill enough into people so they will quit fighting with each other and peeling off."

What are you doing hanging around playing with emotions? You let the devil talk you out of prayer. You are not going to be very happy in eternity that that rat beat you out of your reward.

Why the eighth operation? Because it is the operation you enter the government of God upon, born again and filled with the Holy Ghost. It is supposed to be simultaneous. You are not supposed to have one without the other.

That is the level where we enter God's government because that is the level where we release Him to get involved on the inside of our spirit.

The reason Paul called it diversities of tongues is because there are four major diversities of this supernatural language.

The first is tongues for personal edification.

The second is tongues that present themselves in a public assembly for the sole purpose of interpretation.

The third is tongues that extend into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit and empower a believer to stand in the gap for his family, city, and nation before his God.

The fourth is tongues that transcend your intellect and empower you to preach, teach, or testify in any language you had no previous knowledge of. That is a sign to the unbeliever personified. Suddenly your interpreter falls down dead, the ushers carry him out, and the Holy Spirit rises up, and you begin to speak in that language. Pretty soon they are crawling out of their chairs on their knees, and you are saying, "What did I say?" They say, "You did not say anything. It is what He said."

Last night we started to examine the life-changing forces of two of those diversities. Two are designed for public use: tongues for interpretation and tongues as a sign to the unbeliever. Two are designed by God for your private use, even if you are in a prayer group: tongues for personal edification and tongues that extend into deep intercessional groanings. Those two are as different from each other as night and day.

I wish I could speak with tongues as a sign to the unbeliever anytime I want. I cannot. I know I cannot. I have tried it.

I wish I could slip over into tongues for deep intercessional groanings anytime I want. I cannot. If I could, I would fill this place in a month.

I wish I could even operate in tongues for interpretation anytime I want. I cannot. How do I know? I have tried it. Why would he say, "Let him pray that he may interpret," if the interpretation is always automatic?

There is only one diversity of tongues, one-fourth of them, that I can operate in anytime I want, as much as I want, just because I want to. All the rest are designed by God to flow through you for the edification of others. This fourth diversity is designed by God to flow to you for your own personal edification.

He has done with this one what He has done with no other in the eighth operation. In your spirit where God lives, He has made you the steward of your own operation and the steward of your own edification, because He has released that gift to you to use any time you please.

You must understand who has come to the inside of you to take up His abode. The other day, when I was standing in the prayer center, God started talking to me and humbled me hard. He said, "People consider it a sacrifice to come and spend three hours in prayer two or three times a week. They consider it a sacrifice."

That is when the revelation hit. They consider it a sacrifice to report their precious self-exalted time down to an auditorium, a sacrifice to let God pray for them for three hours. Just in case we are so stupid that we do not know how to pray in English, He brought His own prayer language. It is called tongues. And you consider it a sacrifice to hold up somewhere for three hours and let God issue forth prayers on behalf of changing your program from the inside out and dealing with your character flaws?

Think about Him. He is the One who had to come and live with you.

You have to know who has come to take up His abode.

I know how the religious mind thinks. It thinks, "God! Jehovah! Wow, God!" Then you step down a step and say, "Jesus, my Redeemer." Then you step down another step and say, "The Holy Spirit. Yes, I was baptized. I spoke with tongues three years ago."

You do not know what you got.

Before the universe came into existence, the Godhead coexisted, one with another, coequal in every aspect. All three stood face to face. The Greek breakdown says their breaths were blasting in each other's faces, at their eyes and ears. They stood in a triune triangle, face to face, coequal in every aspect and every way.

When you say God created the universe, you are saying the three persons of God, acting as one, brought the thing into existence. You cannot step down when you start analyzing that you received the Holy Spirit. What is the matter with you? You cannot step down.

Only for the role of creation and redemption did the triune Godhead take on the roles of planner, Creator-Redeemer, caretaker, and regenerator: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.

John 1:1 says:

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

The same was in the beginning with God.

All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.

The Greek puts a pigtail on it: no, not one single thing.

In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, was the Logos. The Logos was with Jehovah, face to face, coequal with the mighty Jehovah in every aspect. All things were made by the Logos.

God the Father took the role as planner and planned the entire universe. The mighty Logos took the role as Creator, and all things were made by Him. Without Him was not anything made that was made.

The fourteenth verse says:

And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us...

Inevitably the day will come when you will behold the Lamb face to face, not through a glass darkly, through the veil of this flesh, but face to face. You will know as you are known, and that is speaking with respect to love. You will finally see the culmination of the love of God in the person of Jesus Christ and finally know and understand the love He has loved you with the whole time.

You will stand face to face with that glorified Man who is as much God as He is man. That is why the ark of the covenant was gopher wood overlaid with gold, and inside the ark were the broken tablets and Aaron's rod that budded, representations of man's sin that Jesus took into Himself. The wood represented His humanity and the gold His deity.

In His humanity as a glorified Man, He has made you His equal, wrapped His arm around you, and called you His brethren. But that glorified Man is as much God as the mighty Jehovah, and every grain of sand you are standing on came from the substance of that Being we have come to know and love as Jesus.

When the Holy Spirit took the role as regenerator, He moved into your life and said, "I will take the same power I restored a dead planet back to life with and restore this fallen Adamic race back to God. If they are so stupid they do not know how to pray, I will bring My own prayer language along with Me so we can get something done."

It is called the eighth operation, tongues for personal edification.

The Holy Ghost is in here. He is in me. He is in you. My friend, the filling of your operation is every bit as important as the fulfilling of mine. Do not let anyone diminish you. Do not let preachers come in and think they are something and diminish you and treat you like you are a dog. You are not a dog. Your call is as important as mine, and mine as yours. I am supposed to introduce you to the Holy Ghost so He can introduce you to your call.

He will purge the reason you are failing right out of you, if you give Him a chance. It is through the Spirit that you mortify.

Look again at verse 29:

Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?

Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?

At one time that would give me problems until the Holy Spirit spoke to me one day and said, "Do you not think you are rather ignorant concerning this verse?"

He made me keep looking at the eighth operation. It is called diversities of tongues. Notice that at the end of this, he tagged "Do all speak with tongues?" as an operation of God, and "Do all interpret?" He was talking about the second diversity, tongues for interpretation, not the first one where He makes His entry into your spirit and begins to pray for your broken-down old character. He is talking about the second diversity. That is why he tagged, "Do all interpret?"

Not everyone is used in tongues and interpretation. You can pray that way, but not everyone is used that way. But everyone has been called to receive the Holy Spirit, and Paul says, "Forbid not to speak with tongues."

Then he went on to say something incredible:

But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

That word "covet" is so strong that in the Ten Commandments He warned against the negative use of it: "Thou shalt not covet." It is such a lustful, intense burning that it will drag you along against your will if possible. But when you turn it to the positive, he says, "Covet earnestly the best gifts," meaning to be consumed from the inside to lay hold of, grasp, and propel to yourself the best gifts.

I can settle the controversy on what the best gift is. When you find out what operation He separated you to, you will find out what gift to covet. If it is helps, governments, pastor, evangelist, He has gifts that go with your operation, and you are to covet them, lay hold of them in relentless pursuit of the best qualifying gifts.

Then he said the most incredible thing:

And yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

A more excellent way to do what? To apprehend the fullness of everything God has called you to be.

I may lay hold of the ministry because my father was a preacher, the mantle may have been passed down, and I may covet to do good because my daddy did good. I may drag myself into church because I know it is the best thing for my family, but my heart is not really in it. There may be a

thousand reasons. The preacher may preach hellfire until torment is reeking out of every cell in my body, and I am so afraid of God I cannot spit. All I have to do is stay out of church for three weeks, and I will forget what he said.

That is not going to take me the gauntlet. You can preach responsibility: "What is the matter with you, irresponsible bunch of sheep?" I will tell you what is the matter with them. They are a mirror. You are looking at yourself.

You can preach the heaviness of responsibility, my friend, and that will only hold them so long. That is why he says, "Covet earnestly the best gifts, and yet I show you a more excellent way" to apprehend the fullness of everything God has called you to be.

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity...

If I do not develop the love of God, I am sounding brass and a tinkling cymbal.

If you want to save yourself a lot of time, go after the love of God. The reason he mentioned the ability to speak with tongues of men and angels before he mentioned love is because you may be able to speak with it, but that is a far cry from using it. If you use it, my friend, you are going to be on the hot pursuit of love.

That love, charity, is loving action. Then he sets off a sequence of events. The progression is in divine order. The subject is apprehending love. The rest is the sequence in the order it takes place.

Watch this divine order from the eighth operation:

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity...

You can be filled with the Holy Ghost and still be hateful.

The next progression that results from praying in tongues is prophecy:

And though I have the gift of prophecy...

Tongues and interpretation equal prophecy. If I suddenly speak a mystery out of my spirit that God prompted me to speak, then I speak to you the meaning of that mystery after getting your attention in your spirit. That is an interpretation.

A prophecy is when God reaches down and pulls a mystery out that is already in your spirit. That is why it is the simple gift for edification, exhortation, and comfort, not for guiding people's lives with. Romans 12 says, "Let him prophesy according to the proportion of faith" delivered to him. You cannot prophesy outside of the understanding of the mysteries inside your spirit. If He has nothing to pull out, you are a dumb prophet.

Watch the next one:

| ...and understand all mysteries...

What mysteries are we talking about? Go to 1 Corinthians 14:2:

| For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God...

Your spirit is in divine communication with God Himself.

| ...for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries.

It is not tongues for interpretation. It is tongues for edification.

The mysteries are the same mysteries God made reference to when He said Paul was made a minister of the manifold wisdom and mysteries of God. These are the same mysteries hidden in God since before the foundation of the world, but now made available to you and me, the Church dispensation of grace, because God the Holy Ghost has moved in.

If I pray in tongues and understand all mysteries, the mystery He is talking about is Christ in you, the hope of glory. Everything He is in me, to me, and through me, the hope of glory.

Paul prayed in tongues and said, "I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than you all." It was responsible for three-quarters of the revelation knowledge recorded in the New Testament. Where did he get it? His spirit continually communed with God, and God continually answered. Divine secrets and mysteries hidden from the ages have now been made manifest to the Church of God: Christ in you, the hope of glory.

Now we are taking that eighth operation up. We are empowered with prophecy in helps and governments, and mysteries so we can understand how to run our helps and governments ministry just like Jesus would. All He does inside of you is want to government. All He does inside of you is want to help. All He does inside a teacher is want to teach. Inside a missionary, He just wants to take him overseas and win the lost. That is all Christ in you wants to do, and that mystery will come out.

Pardon me, you do not have time to pray.

The next progression:

| ...and have all knowledge...

What is He talking about? He who searches my heart, the Holy Spirit, does it knowing what God's mind is for my life. He makes intercession for me according to the will of God.

If my operation is helps and governments, He may make me a multi-billionaire businessman. I will pray the mystery of what Christ is to me in that area, and that fastens a pillar, a great white pillar like a Roman temple. Then I pray mysteries until I understand the principles of giving and

receiving, and another pillar is erected. I step over here and pray the mystery of love into my heart, reaping for the lost, until the whole building is built. The building represents knowledge.

What does that produce?

...and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains...

Notice the kind of faith he is talking about: all faith, so that I could move mountains.

Then after mountain-moving faith, he talks about ultimate giving:

And though I bestow all my goods to feed the poor...

This man came to the place where he could give his body to be burned, and still Paul says if I have not charity, I am nothing. I am sounding brass and a tinkling cymbal.

That lowly gift, tongues of men and angels, set off the progression: prophecy, mysteries, knowledge, faith, giving, and love.

Let us talk about personal edification and the deep intercessional groanings for a moment. If you thought revival was easy, then why can you count on two hands in any generation the man, woman, or group of intercessors who brought it?

If the devil were not a conniving, scheming, murdering, devious genius, then why did every group that jumped up and screamed, "We are going to pray revival into our city," end up a year later where hardly anyone knows their name?

You remember last year when all you people flowed out and said, "We are going to..." Boy, that was a wonderful five weeks. What did you last, four months?

If you think you are up against a foe who does not have your number and has not studied you for six thousand years, ask yourself why they are not bringing revival. Do you want to know how the devil works? You do not need to look at somebody slobbering as a devil comes out of them. That is not where the real fight is for you. He has something much more ingenious planned for you.

Jesus said you would have to be wise as serpents and harmless as doves. If the devil did not strike to kill, Jesus would not have said that. When the devil strikes, he does not plan on you surviving the blow.

You know how much smarter God is than the devil? "I cannot use venom to kill with, and I am still smarter than that." He would not say you had to be wise as a serpent and harmless as a dove if Satan's arsenal were not full of weaponry that can only be combated by the Holy Ghost wisdom of God.

Where do you think these denominational barns lining the streets came from? You walk into their churches, and they are denying half the things some of them once wrote. Some have rewritten Bibles. Some are praying to saints now. You walk in and ask, "Is your doctrine inspired by God?" and they will throw you out on your ear. They will say, "Yes, it is." Where did these twentieth-century intelligent men come to that conclusion if they are not up against a conniving, scheming, murderous foe full of wisdom, or with him?

God gave you the Holy Ghost, and you will not use Him, then wonder why.

I always wondered why Paul called himself the chiefest of sinners. How could this be? A Pharisee of the Pharisees, concerning the law blameless. If he made the statement, he meant it. To carry out every precept, concept, and ordinance of the law required a man with character steel. Do not kid yourself. From the age of three, he studied the law seven hours a day in memorization. He said, "Concerning my peers in my generation, I excelled beyond all of them."

Yet he said, "Those things I counted gain, I count them but dung, that I may know Him, that I may be found in Him, not having my own righteousness which is of the law."

A man like that called himself the chiefest of sinners. When Jesus Christ of Nazareth intercepted Saul of Tarsus, breathing out slaughterings and threatenings on the road to Damascus, Saul said, "Who is this?"

He said, "It is Jesus, whom you persecute. It is hard to kick against the pricks. You are losing if you are kicking this thing. You are fighting a losing battle."

Paul called himself the chiefest of sinners because he was leading people away from God and the born-again experience while believing he was doing God a service.

So tell me, who is the chiefest of sinners, the drug king who arrests your children's bodies with addictive habits that destroy them, or the religious witness who leads them away from Jesus? Bring those boys Jesus, and they may take Him. Bring Jesus to a religious witness hardened against Him, and he may throw you out on your ear.

You want to look at the devil face to face? He is not merely slobbering coming out of someone. Look back over five years of your life, not understanding that the rewards maintained throughout eternity are what you worked here, yet you did nothing, and you wonder what the devil looks like. There is not a saint who ever lived who did not have to overcome him to do something.

What do you want, an excuse?

The weapons of our warfare are not carnal. Give it up. They are mighty through God to the pulling down of strongholds, fortresses. You do not have to go far to find out what kind of fortresses he is talking about. The next verse says it: casting down imaginations, elaborate systems of thought that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God.

The strongholds are systems of thought that have the audacity to exalt themselves against the knowledge of God with the intent to unseat Him in your life.

Yet He gave you the eighth operation. He said if you speak with tongues, you speak in mysteries of everything Christ is in you, the hope of glory. You are activating the anointing in you that cannot lie and teaches you all things.

Concerning those who seduce you, you have no need that any man teach you, but that anointing you received of Him abides in you and is truth and cannot lie. Is he saying to do away with teachers? No. But concerning those who seduce you, you have no need that any man teach you.

What if I am the one seducing you? How am I going to open you up and put an anointing in you that will tell you you are being seduced? How am I going to open you up and put love in there? How am I going to open you up and put initiative in there? How am I going to open you up and take away the hurt and pain from abortions and molestation?

I cannot. But I can turn you over to Him who can. He has been charged above all to reveal Jesus in you. His name is the Holy Ghost.

I will tell you what will happen. You learn the art of enduring prayer. Give a little of your self-exalted life up. Learn the art of sitting with a group of people. I cannot wait for the day we have ten thousand prayer people in Tulsa. Do you want to know who the unsung heroes will be? They will be sung in heaven: your prayer people.

You sit there and learn the art of enduring prayer. It does not matter if you are screaming, except that you wear yourself out.

"I am screaming at the devil."

No, you are not. You are in the first stages of personal edification. You are not screaming at anybody. You are changing yourself. So just shut up and sit there and whisper or pray quietly under your breath, but keep on praying.

The days will go by. The weeks will go by. The months will go by. You sit there, and those mysteries will start activating and casting light into every dark area of your life. Those obstacles that kept you from winning last year will be dragged screaming and kicking into full examination.

Even if you are self-exalted, the Holy Ghost will bring you face to face with yourself. He starts dragging those things out, and some of them do not want to die.

Self-exaltation is a hard one to kill. You get to praying, and pretty soon it declares war on your mind: "I am not giving my position up." The anointing rises and says, "Give it up. Give it up." Pretty soon you run to people who say, "You can pray too much in the Holy Ghost."

"Let me tell you what happened to me last year. I prayed six months and got depressed."

You would not let that thing die.

Some of you are captured by tight-fistedness. You cannot come down and pray in the Holy Ghost because He deals with your character. You quit and keep your money. Enjoy it. You are not taking it with you.

If you think you will have a position in heaven, you will have one in the crowd, just like you are now. If you know how the Father honored the Lamb for shedding His blood, He is the talk of the universe. Anybody who gives their life for it is the talk of the universe. The exaltation and honor of the Lamb is the most sought-after thing in the entire universe, and you are throwing it away because you are full of flesh.

You pray five or six months, depending on how deeply buried those things are that ceiling your life, those handles that stick out. Every time you try to do something for God, the devil comes by and twists them until your emotions overpower you and you fail again. Why? You have handles. The Holy Ghost's job is to mortify them.

Through the Spirit you mortify. Through the eighth operation you pray, and pretty soon these handles start falling off.

"I had the roughest time in prayer. I came depressed for three months and prayed, but I found out even though I did not feel like I was getting through, I was producing even more than when I was free-flowing."

Yes, you were, because you were getting past what stopped your life last time.

Then handle after handle dies. One day God comes by for an examination and says, "They only have a few little insignificant handles left. I do not believe the devil can use them hardly." God picks you up by the nape of the neck and says, "My daughter, it is time for intercession. I have had a bunch of people going to hell for months and could not find anybody to stop them, but you have gotten rid of your handles."

Suddenly, supernaturally, not severally as you will, but severally as He wills, He comes upon you. You find yourself in a compassionate, sometimes lost state. You feel so lost that agony comes, and you cry and bawl because God is actually using your authority.

You have authority in two realms: the kingdom of God and the kingdoms of this earth, because you have a body and a born-again spirit. He comes through your authority and says, "Let Me pour through you. I can stop this thing if somebody will lend their authority to Me."

"Here I am. It is me."

He places you on the path, and those people run into you, and six hundred get born again. They cannot get past.

Then you come out of it like you went in. Pretty soon the devil lets the prince over Tucson send a telegram to Phoenix saying, "Look, there is something about to break loose here that is going to really damage our kingdom. I need reinforcements. There is this blasted woman who has made it through to second-phase operation, and we have got to stop her."

He will come and examine you for handles. If he can get hold of one, he will twist it and make you wish you were never born. He will try to go through your family. He will dig a hole a mile deep and put everything in it that means anything to you and bury it. He will fight you tooth and nail.

But he cannot destroy you because peace is dominating.

God will flow to you until He can identify you and bring you to a place where He can flow through you. But it is not without great cost, because the devil will come. If the devil can destroy you, do not kid yourself, God cannot use you in intercession.

Why do you think there are very few revivals? God loves me. He is not going to slide me into that gap if the devil can jump on me and destroy me. But when I qualify, I have the same privileges as the apostle Paul.

"Oh Lord, that I may have a messenger straight from the throne room of hell assigned to me to stop me, that I would be that dangerous. What a reward stacked up."

It is not without cost that the devil turns loose of a city.

You can think what you want. It does not make any difference. But I suggest you learn the art of enduring prayer.

These four power flows will eventually visit you.

Number one is tongues for personal edification, the revelation gift. Mysteries, knowledge, understanding of the Word, love forces, and initiatives are put into you during that time.

Number two is when you hit impasses. It slides you into a minor form of intercession where you are actually feeling the load of those things, but at the same time your spirit is putting them to death.

The second power flow is a slight, low degree of groanings and intercession.

The third power flow is full-blown deep intercessional groanings, which are every bit as powerful as the workings of miracles. To throw people out of wheelchairs and watch them run off is the effect you have in the Spirit when you enter into groanings. You save people's lives. He can place you between catastrophes like the San Francisco earthquake. He can place you in there and save people's lives so they can be born again.

God is not sending anybody to hell. That is an intercession. It is incredible.

The fourth power flow that will visit you from time to time in enduring prayer is waves of glory, joy, and hilarious laughter. The Holy Spirit passes through you with a report that says, "A strong man has fallen." Joy, hilarious laughter, glory. You may stay under it for an hour, wave after wave. You actually visit heaven while you are here. Heaven comes.

I do not care about going to heaven now. I brought it here.

We are going to take it further tomorrow night.

There is a Father.